

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding?

Answer Choices:

- A. Radial artery
- B. Ulnar artery
- C. Princeps pollicis artery
- D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , we need to identify the artery that is most likely damaged given the anatomical location and the type of injury . The anatomical snuffbox is a region of the hand that includes the metacarpal heads and the pisiform bone , which is close to the styloid process of the ulna .

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<answer>

B. Ulnar artery

</answer>

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The anatomical snuffbox is supplied by the ulnar artery , which runs through the anatomic snuffbox and branches to supply the thumb , index , and middle fingers . A penetrating stab wound in this region would most likely damage the ulnar artery , leading to excessive bleeding .

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